widdexBDP

LATAM BUSINESS GUIDE · 03 | TECHNOLOGY

Technology Adoption in Latin America: How Ready Is Each Market?

A country-by-country view of digital connectivity, payments, artificial intelligence, cloud infrastructure and enterprise maturity in Chile, Peru, Argentina, Colombia and Mexico, and what it means for selling technology in the region.

Latin America is one of the fastest-digitizing regions in the world, but technology adoption is uneven. Consumers adopt mobile apps and digital wallets quickly, while many companies, especially small and medium-sized ones, are still in the early stages of digital transformation. For a foreign technology company, the level of adoption in each market determines **what to sell, to whom, how to price it and how much education the market needs**. Choosing the wrong entry market can mean selling an advanced solution to buyers who are not yet ready, or arriving late to a market that has already matured.

1.1 GW	3,000+	53%	#1
data center colocation capacity in LATAM, +20% in 2025	fintech companies across Latin America & the Caribbean	of mobile connections expected on 5G by 2030 (GSMA)	Chile's rank in the Latin American AI Index (ILIA 2025)

Our adoption framework

To compare the five markets, Widdex BDP groups technology readiness into five dimensions and four adoption levels, combining public indicators with our field experience in B2B sales across the region.

Adoption level	What it means for a foreign technology company
Leader	Buyers understand the technology, run pilots and compare vendors. Competition is higher, but sales cycles are shorter and references travel well across the region.
Advanced	Strong adoption in specific segments or large companies. Clear demand exists, but buyers expect local proof points and support.
Adopter	Growing interest and early implementations. Education, pilots and ROI cases are needed; first movers can build strong positions.
Emerging	Adoption limited to a few large players or early users. Long-term opportunity, but significant market education is required.

Technology adoption heat map

Dimension	Chile	Peru	Argentina	Colombia	Mexico
Connectivity & internet use	Leader	Adopter	Advanced	Adopter	Advanced
Digital payments & fintech	Advanced	Advanced	Advanced	Leader	Advanced
AI readiness (ILIA 2025)	Leader	Adopter	Adopter	Advanced	Adopter
Cloud & data center infrastructure	Advanced	Emerging	Adopter	Adopter	Advanced
Enterprise digital maturity	Advanced	Adopter	Advanced	Adopter	Advanced
SME digital maturity	Adopter	Emerging	Adopter	Adopter	Emerging

Assessment by Widdex BDP based on the indicators cited in this guide and field experience; levels are relative within the five markets.

Artificial intelligence readiness: ILIA 2025

The Latin American Artificial Intelligence Index (ILIA), published by ECLAC and Chile's National Center for Artificial Intelligence (CENIA), measures AI enablers, research and development, and governance across 19 countries. It is a useful proxy for how ready each market is to adopt advanced digital solutions.

Country	ILIA 2025 score	Regional position	Category
Chile	70.6 / 100	1st of 19	Pioneer
Colombia	55.8 / 100	4th	Adopter
Argentina	53.0 / 100	6th	Adopter
Peru	51.9 / 100	7th	Adopter
Mexico	47.0 / 100	8th	Adopter
Reference: Brazil / Uruguay	67.4 / 62.3	2nd / 3rd	Pioneer

Country profiles

CHILE Regional leader: the natural test market

Key indicators	Around 91% internet penetration, the highest of the five markets; ranked 1st in the ILIA 2025 AI index; early 5G deployment; Santiago is one of the region's main data center hubs, with about 10% of the capacity under construction in Latin America.
Adoption profile	Large corporates in mining, banking, retail and utilities are sophisticated technology buyers. An open finance framework under the Fintech Law is driving financial innovation.
Buyer behavior	Formal procurement, demanding technical evaluations and preference for proven references; once adopted, solutions scale across group companies.
Best fit for	AI and data analytics, cybersecurity, mining technology, cloud services, B2B SaaS, fintech and energy technology.

MEXICO Scale with a two-speed digital economy

Key indicators	86.1% of the population aged 6+ uses the internet (104.9 million people, INEGI 2025); 37% of internet users buy online; Querétaro is a leading data center hub; ranked 8th in ILIA 2025.
Adoption profile	Two speeds: export-oriented manufacturers and large corporates in the north and Bajío adopt Industry 4.0 and cloud quickly, while many SMEs remain cash-based and lightly digitized.
Buyer behavior	Relationship-driven and hierarchical; large deals take time but are significant in size. Strong US influence on technology standards.
Best fit for	Industrial automation, supply-chain and logistics software, e-commerce enablement, cybersecurity, data centers and fintech for SMEs.

COLOMBIA Fintech and payments frontrunner

Key indicators	Bre-B instant payments reached 36 million users and more than COP 262 trillion moved in its first year; about 13% of the region's fintechs; ranked 4th in ILIA 2025.
Adoption profile	Fast adoption of digital financial services and an active startup ecosystem in Bogotá and Medellín. Mid-market companies are actively digitizing.
Buyer behavior	Open to innovation and pilots, price-sensitive, and expect local implementation support and Spanish-language service.
Best fit for	Payments, open finance, digital banking infrastructure, SaaS for mid-market companies, customer experience and BPO technology.

ARGENTINA	Digital talent and sophisticated users
Key indicators	Around 86% internet penetration; about 10% of the region's fintechs; ranked 6th in ILIA 2025; home of some of the region's largest technology companies.
Adoption profile	Very high consumer digital adoption and world-class software talent, but enterprise technology investment is constrained by inflation, currency rules and tight budgets.
Buyer behavior	Technically sophisticated and demanding; strong focus on price, payment terms and currency. Decisions accelerate when the ROI is clear.
Best fit for	Energy and mining technology linked to RIGI projects, agtech, cost-saving and efficiency solutions, and partnerships with local software firms.

PERU	Mobile-first and fast-moving consumers
Key indicators	Around 72% internet penetration, the lowest of the five markets; the Yape wallet reports 16.4 million monthly active users averaging 67 transactions a month; ranked 7th in ILIA 2025.
Adoption profile	Consumers leapfrogged to mobile wallets, while many companies remain in early stages. Mining and large financial groups are the main technology buyers.
Buyer behavior	Concentrated decision-making in large groups; technology adoption follows clear business cases and local references.
Best fit for	Mining technology, mobile and digital financial services, logistics, agro-export technology and solutions for formalizing SMEs.

Payments and regulation: practical checkpoints

Two practical questions shape every technology sale in the region: how customers pay, and which data rules apply. Both differ significantly by country.

Market	Leading digital payment rails	Data protection framework
Chile	Cards, bank transfers and digital wallets; open finance being implemented under the Fintech Law	New Personal Data Protection Law (Law 21.719) with a new data protection agency, taking effect in December 2026; Cybersecurity Framework Law in force
Peru	Yape and Plin wallets, interoperable with banks	Personal Data Protection Law 29733, with new regulations in force since 2025
Argentina	Mercado Pago and interoperable QR payments; strong use of bank transfers	Law 25.326; recognized by the European Union as providing adequate data protection, which simplifies EU data transfers
Colombia	Bre-B instant payments, Nequi and Daviplata	Law 1581 of 2012, actively enforced by the Superintendence of Industry and Commerce
Mexico	SPEI interbank transfers, cards and Mercado Pago; cash still relevant for SMEs	New Federal Law on Protection of Personal Data Held by Private Parties, enacted in 2025

For European vendors

GDPR-compliant products are generally well positioned, because the new Latin American data protection laws follow similar principles. Still, local requirements on consent, data transfers, registration and incident notification differ by country and should be reviewed with local counsel before launch.

Where technology demand is heading

Based on current investment, regulation and buyer conversations, these are the technology priorities most likely to generate B2B demand in each market over the next 12 to 24 months.

Market	Top technology priorities for buyers	Main buyers
Chile	AI and advanced analytics, cybersecurity and data protection compliance, mining automation and decarbonization, energy management	Mining, banking, utilities, retail, public sector
Mexico	Industrial automation and IoT, supply-chain visibility, cybersecurity, cloud migration, SME payments and e-commerce	Manufacturers, logistics, retail, financial services
Colombia	Open finance and business payments on Bre-B, digital banking, customer experience and AI for service operations	Banks, fintechs, BPO, retail, telecom
Argentina	Efficiency and cost-reduction software, energy and mining technology for RIGI projects, agtech	Energy, mining, agribusiness, technology firms

Market	Top technology priorities for buyers	Main buyers
Peru	Mining technology and safety, digital financial services, logistics, SME formalization and digitization	Mining, financial groups, agro-exporters

Go-to-market implications

- **Start where adoption matches your product's maturity.** Advanced AI, data or cloud solutions tend to find faster traction in Chile and in large Mexican corporates; payments and fintech infrastructure in Colombia and Mexico.
- **Use Chile as a reference market.** A successful implementation with a recognized Chilean corporate is a strong credential for selling in Peru, Colombia and beyond.
- **Adapt the business model to the adoption level.** Where SMEs are less digitized, simpler packages, local-currency pricing, onboarding support and channel partners are essential.
- **Invest in education and proof.** In Adopter markets, pilots, workshops and ROI cases do more than feature lists. Local case studies accelerate every subsequent sale.
- **Plan local support from the start.** Spanish-language implementation, service-level commitments and a local point of contact are often decisive in vendor selection.

Key takeaway

Technology adoption in Latin America is high among consumers and uneven among companies. **Chile** leads overall and is the best testbed, **Colombia** leads in payments, **Mexico** offers scale with a two-speed economy, **Argentina** combines talent with macro constraints, and **Peru** is mobile-first with concentrated corporate demand. Matching the product to the market's adoption level is the key to a fast start.

HOW WIDDEX BDP CAN HELP

Bring your technology to the right market, faster

Widdex BDP helps innovative technology companies enter Latin America through hands-on business development, not just reports. We assess your product's fit with each market's adoption level, design a localized go-to-market strategy with the right Ideal Customer Profile, messaging and pricing, open doors with technology decision-makers in Mexico, Colombia, Argentina, Peru and Chile, and lead the pilots that become your first local references. As your fractional LATAM leadership team, we deliver **a shorter path to the first contracts**, **lower risk and investment** by validating demand before building a local team, **credible local references** that unlock the rest of the region, and **a turn-key Fractional HQ in Chile** to scale your operation across Latin America with governance, banking and multi-country coordination.

Let's talk Francisco Amigo, Managing Partner · www.widdex.com · linkedin.com/in/franciscoamigog

Sources & notes

ECLAC & CENIA, Latin American AI Index (ILIA) 2025, via Bloomberg Línea · INEGI ENDUTIH 2025, June 2026 · Banco de la República / El País Colombia, October 2026 · Descubre.vc, May 2026 (Yape) · JLL via Bloomberg Línea, March 2026 (data centers) · GSMA, The Mobile Economy Latin America 2025 · Finnovista & IDB Fintech Report 2024 · Internet penetration for Chile, Argentina, Colombia and Peru: Widdex BDP market overview · Adoption levels: Widdex BDP assessment